

Session Numbers & Durations

Based on a review of sport organisation guidelines and athlete development literature, recommendations for the optimal number of practice session per week and practice length are provided in the table. Limiting practice sessions to 90 and 120 minutes might seem counterintuitive to popular cultural depictions of what it takes to succeed in sport (e.g., we must train longer and harder than our opponents!)

AGE GROUP	COACH/PLAYER RATIO	NUMBER OF PRACTICES	PRACTICE DURATION
Under 6	1 : 4	1-2 days per week	45-60 minutes
Under 8	1 : 8	2 days per week	60-75 minutes
Under 10	1 : 8	2 days per week	60-90 minutes
Under 12	1 : 8	2-3 days per week	75-90 minutes
Under 14	1 : 10	3 days per week	75-90 minutes
Under 16	1 : 12	3-4 days per week	90-120 minutes
Under 17 years old and older	1 : 12	4-5 days per week	90-120 minutes